

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, freight automation.*

Positioning, I own complex operational product areas from discovery to measurable outcome, in B2B SaaS environments where the work is still mostly done by email and spreadsheet.

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§ WHY ZENCARGO

Freight forwarding is one of the last large industries where the core workflow is still an email thread. Zencargo is going after that directly: combining a full-stack forwarding operation with Luca, an AI co-pilot that turns exception management from reactive fire-fighting into a proactive loop. That is an interesting product problem, not just a digitisation project. The posting specifically calls out exception management and operational automation as product areas, exactly the kind of work where process mapping, data instrumentation, and tight discovery loops with operational users produce outsized results. *That is where I have delivered consistently, and the kind of environment I work best in.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and prototypes
- **Cursor**, codebase exploration with engineers
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired with engineers in reviews
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, user-research synthesis, edge-case generation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder and leadership decks
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Claude**, discovery analysis, PRD drafting

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Docker, OpenShift, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built solo from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made, reduces friction without eliminating trust.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, keeping acquisition cost near zero on both sides of the market.
 - LLM agents across the full funnel so one person runs the day-to-day; funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.
 - Directly relevant to Zencargo: two-sided marketplace with freight-partner and customer dynamics, and AI automation reducing manual coordination, the same core problem.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT ZENCARGO

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with operations and customer-facing teams, trace a shipment end-to-end through the current platform, identify where Luca is already reducing manual work and where exception management still falls back to email.

WEEK 2

Validate and sharpen.

Run structured sessions with two or three operational users to validate the problem ranking from week one, agree what a measurable outcome looks like, and produce a first rough prioritisation for the squad.

Own and ship.

Take clear ownership of one initiative into delivery, with agreed success measures defined before the first line of code, and instrument it so we know whether it lands.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Zencargo team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role. I have 13 years owning product areas in operationally complex B2B SaaS environments, insurance, defence AI, public-sector analytics, healthcare, and payments, and the through-line in every role has been the same: take a process that runs on emails and spreadsheets, map it properly, find where technology reduces friction, and ship something measurable.

That description fits Zencargo's problem statement almost exactly. The posting names exception management, booking and shipment workflows, and purchase-order management as candidate areas. These are not abstract product domains; they are concrete operational processes where the gap between what the system can do and what users actually do is usually visible the moment you sit next to someone and watch. I have closed that kind of gap before: at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I instrumented two competing workflows and found the more polished one had zero real usage, the data-first path the team considered secondary was where all the work actually happened. That analysis redirected the entire development quarter.

On AI: I use Claude Code, Cursor, Lovable, and GPT daily as part of how I do discovery and prototyping, and I have shipped AI-powered features in production. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, managing a 15-person cross-functional team. I know the difference between AI features that reduce real operational load and AI features that look impressive in a demo. Luca sounds like the former, and I would rather help make that distinction clearly than add features for their own sake.

I do not have a background in freight forwarding specifically. My logistics knowledge comes from my Diplom-Wirtschaftsingenieur studies at TU Berlin, where logistics was my specialisation. The operational complexity, multiple parties, exception-heavy workflows, time-sensitive decisions with imperfect data, is familiar from defence programme coordination and public-sector data platforms. Domain gaps at the application layer close quickly when the underlying product skills are already there.

I am based in Berlin, available at four weeks' notice, and happy to work remotely or to discuss on-site arrangements. I would welcome a conversation about the specific product area and what the squad is currently focused on.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership in operationally complex B2B SaaS environments: logistics, defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, and payments. I run continuous discovery, turn strategy, user needs, and technical constraints into prioritised roadmaps, and lead cross-functional squads through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe). I use AI tools daily across discovery, prototyping, and specification, and I have shipped AI-powered features in production.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design. I instrumented two competing workflows and the beautiful UI-led one recorded exactly zero clicks.
- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new supply chain indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update cycle.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, freeing several QA hours every week; migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL,
MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework) setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

Government, secure data platform.

- Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; platform is still in production.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019-12/2019

Wind energy.

- Full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017-06/2018

Healthcare, clinical network.

- Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL |
12/2025-06/2026

Construction staffing, two-sided B2B marketplace.

- Zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN |
01/2016-12/2021

IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes after enterprise buyers rejected longer installation. Later Chair of the board.

Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments.

- Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse, inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP (minimum viable product) definition, PoC (proof of concept), A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement (grooming), sprint planning, daily stand-up, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT (user acceptance testing), Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM (large language model) agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Lovable.

Agile and Scaled Delivery (SDLC): Agile, Scrum, Kanban, WIP (work in progress) limits, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI (key performance indicator) definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), PostgreSQL, supply chain data pipelines.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes (K8s), OpenShift, Docker, GitOps with ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management and expectation alignment, cross-functional team leadership, C-level and executive reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance and Business: GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation, DSGVO), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning as CFO, ROI (return on investment) reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · ZENCARGO

